BUILD YOUR AI CEO — THE COMPLETE SETUP GUIDE

Module 4D — Your AI Control Room: First Contact

Start Your Gateway, Send Your First Message, and Meet Your AI CEO

MODULE 4D — DOWNLOAD PACKET

Step-by-Step Student Setup Guide — Mac and Windows (WSL2)

This Is the Moment!

Everything you've built throughout this course has been leading to this.

You've created your AI CEO's identity, personality, and operating instructions.

You've installed OpenClaw, connected your AI model, and placed your personalized files into its workspace.

You've created your Discord server, invited your bot, and configured the connection between Discord and OpenClaw.

Now it's time to bring everything together.

In this final setup lesson, you'll start OpenClaw, send your first message, and meet your AI CEO for the very first time!

What You'll Accomplish

By the end of this lesson, you will have:

- Validated your OpenClaw configuration
- Started your OpenClaw gateway
- Sent your first message to your AI CEO through Discord
- Confirmed that your AI CEO recognizes its identity and role in your business
- Completed your final setup checklist

> ***Important:*** *If your AI CEO doesn't respond, don't worry. We've included a troubleshooting section at the end of this guide with commands to help identify the problem.*

Before You Start

Make sure you've completed:

- **Module 4A:** Install OpenClaw and connect your AI model
- **Module 4B:** Install your personalized AI CEO files
- **Module 4C:** Connect your Discord bot and configure your Discord settings

Have these ready:

- Your computer with OpenClaw installed
- Terminal on Mac, or Ubuntu/WSL Terminal on Windows
- Your Discord server
- Your `#operator` channel

How to Use This Guide

Whenever you see a Terminal command:

1. Copy the entire command
2. Open Terminal on your Mac, or Ubuntu/WSL Terminal on Windows
3. Paste the command
4. Press Enter
5. Wait for the result before continuing

> ***Windows users:*** *These commands are designed for Ubuntu running through WSL2, not native Windows PowerShell.*
>
> ***Security reminder:*** *Never share your Discord Bot Token, API keys, passwords, or other private credentials in screenshots, public messages, or AI chats.*

Step 1 — Validate Your OpenClaw Configuration

Before starting your AI CEO, we're going to perform one quick check. This confirms that OpenClaw recognizes the configuration you completed in the previous lessons.

1. Open Terminal

Open Terminal on your Mac, or Ubuntu/WSL Terminal on Windows.

2. Run the Validation Command

Copy and run:

▷ TERMINAL COMMAND — COPY & PASTE INTO TERMINAL

```
openclaw config validate
```

3. Review the Result

If OpenClaw reports that your configuration is valid — you're ready to continue.

If OpenClaw reports an error, stop here and review the error message. If needed, use ChatGPT or Grok. Copy and paste the output and ask it to translate in plain language what it means. As always, never paste an API key or token into either.

You can use the troubleshooting section at the end of this guide to help identify the problem.

> ***Important:*** *Don't replace your existing configuration file with a new template or run automatic repair commands without understanding what they will change.*

Step 2 — Start Your OpenClaw Gateway

Now we're going to start OpenClaw.

Think of the gateway as the communication hub that connects your AI CEO to services like Discord.

In Module 4C, we temporarily stopped the gateway while configuring your Discord connection. Now it's time to turn it back on!

1. Return to Terminal

Copy and run:

▷ TERMINAL COMMAND — COPY & PASTE INTO TERMINAL

```
openclaw gateway start
```

2. Wait for the Result

OpenClaw should report the result of attempting to start the gateway. You may see a message indicating that:

- The gateway started successfully
- The gateway is already running
- The gateway is still starting

If the gateway started successfully or is already running, continue to Step 3.

If the gateway is still starting, give it a little time before continuing.

If you see an error, refer to the troubleshooting section at the end of this guide.

> ***Important:*** *Do not repeatedly start new gateway processes. If the gateway service is missing, return to the installation instructions from Module 4A.*

Step 3 — First Contact! Send Your First Message

This is it. The moment you've been working toward!

Your AI CEO's personalized files are installed. Your Discord bot has joined your server. Your OpenClaw gateway has been started.

Now it's time to see everything come together.

1. Open Discord

Open the Discord application on your computer. Select the server you created in Module 3.

2. Open Your Operator Channel

In the left sidebar, click:

```
#operator
```

This is your primary communication channel with your AI CEO. It should be named `[your AI CEO's name]-operator`, or just `operator`.

3. Send Your First Message

In the message box at the bottom of the channel, type the following:

```
Hi [your AI CEO's NAME] — welcome to the team. Today is your first day. Tell me who you are, what you're here to do, and what we're going to build together.
```

Press **Enter**.

4. Wait for Your AI CEO to Respond

Give your AI CEO a moment to process your message.

The first response may take a little longer because OpenClaw may need to initialize the session and contact your selected AI model.

What Success Looks Like

Your AI CEO should reply directly in your `#operator` channel.

Ideally, it will:

- Introduce itself by the name you created
- Describe its role as your AI CEO
- Explain its purpose in your business
- Reflect the identity and instructions you created in Module 1

The exact wording will vary based on your personalized files and selected AI model.

If your AI CEO responds — congratulations! You've officially made First Contact!

Continue to Step 4.

If your AI CEO doesn't respond:

- Don't panic
- Go to the Troubleshooting section at the end of this PDF
- We'll show you how to check your gateway, Discord connection, and AI model
- Once you've resolved the issue, return to this step and try again

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Step 4 — Verify Your AI CEO's Personalization

Now that your AI CEO has responded, let's make sure it's actually using the personalized instructions you created.

Remember — this isn't supposed to be a generic chatbot. You created an identity, a personality, a role, and operating instructions tailored to your business. Let's see whether those instructions are being reflected in its responses.

1. Stay in Your Operator Channel

Remain in `#operator` in Discord, or `#[your AI CEO's name]-operator`.

2. Send Your Second Message

Copy and paste the following:

```
Based on your workspace instructions, what is your role in my business, what are your priorities, and what do you know about me and my business so far?
```

Press **Enter**.

3. Review the Response

Your AI CEO should be able to describe:

- Its name and identity
- Its responsibilities in your business
- The business context you provided
- The details you provided about yourself
- Its main priorities
- The goals or operating principles you defined in Module 1

Compare its response to the personalized files you created earlier in the course.

> ***What you're looking for:*** *A response that reflects your actual instructions and business information, rather than generic or invented details.*

What if the Response Is Too Generic?

If your AI CEO responds but doesn't seem to recognize its personalized identity, don't assume the entire setup failed.

The Discord connection may be working correctly while the workspace configuration still needs attention.

Check that:

- Your personalized files were placed in the correct OpenClaw workspace in Module 4B
- The intended AI agent is using that workspace
- Your identity and business files contain the information you're asking it to recall

If you're unsure how to check these items, use the troubleshooting guidance at the end of this PDF.

Important — About First-Run Onboarding

Depending on your OpenClaw version and workspace setup, your AI CEO may begin with a first-run onboarding conversation.

This may be related to a file called `BOOTSTRAP.md`.

If OpenClaw asks onboarding questions instead of immediately introducing your personalized AI CEO, don't worry.

Review the prompts carefully and make sure they don't conflict with the identity files you've already created.

Do not blindly delete `BOOTSTRAP.md` or overwrite your personalized files.

If you're unsure what to do, use the troubleshooting prompt at the end of this guide and explain that you already installed personalized identity files in Module 4B.

Step 5 — Your Final Readiness Checklist

Before completing Module 4, let's confirm that everything is working. Check off each item as you complete it.

- [ ] I completed Module 4A, 4B, 4C, and 4D
- [ ] My OpenClaw configuration passed validation
- [ ] My OpenClaw gateway started without an unresolved error
- [ ] My Discord bot is present in my server
- [ ] I sent my first message in my `#operator` Discord channel
- [ ] My AI CEO responded to my message
- [ ] My AI CEO introduced its identity and purpose
- [ ] I asked my AI CEO about its role and business priorities
- [ ] Its response reflects my personalized workspace instructions
- [ ] I have kept my Discord Bot Token and API keys private

Congratulations — You Built Your AI CEO!

Take a moment to appreciate what you've accomplished.

You didn't just install a piece of software.

You built the foundation of your own AI-powered business operating system.

You created an AI CEO with a personalized identity, operating instructions, and a communication channel you can use to interact with it.

And now you've successfully exchanged your first messages.

Your AI CEO is officially online!

Remember — this is the beginning.

Additional tools, integrations, scheduled reports, memory workflows, and autonomous tasks can be added and tested as you expand its capabilities.

Start with small, low-risk tasks and build trust in the system before granting access to sensitive accounts or powerful actions.

Troubleshooting — Only if Your AI CEO Doesn't Respond

If your AI CEO didn't respond in Discord, don't worry. There are several common reasons why a connection might not work on the first attempt.

The good news is that OpenClaw includes diagnostic commands that can help identify the problem.

> *You do not need to run all these commands if your AI CEO is already responding correctly. These checks are here to help when something isn't working.*

Check 1 — Is Your OpenClaw Gateway Running?

The gateway is responsible for maintaining the connection between OpenClaw and services like Discord.

Open Terminal and run:

▷ TERMINAL COMMAND — COPY & PASTE INTO TERMINAL

```
openclaw gateway status --deep
```

What to look for: Review the result for information about whether the gateway is running and reachable. If the gateway is stopped, return to Step 2 and start it. If it reports an error, read the message before making changes.

> ***Helpful tip:*** *Terminal output can look complicated, especially for beginners. You can copy the output into ChatGPT and ask it to explain what it means — just remove any API keys, tokens, or passwords first.*

Check 2 — Is Discord Connected?

Next, let's check whether OpenClaw recognizes your Discord connection.

▷ TERMINAL COMMAND — COPY & PASTE INTO TERMINAL

```
openclaw channels status --probe
```

What to look for: Find Discord in the results. Look for a successful connection or probe, and review any warnings or errors.

If the connection isn't working, check the following:

- Your bot was successfully invited to your Discord server
- Message Content Intent is enabled in the Discord Developer Portal
- Your bot has permission to view, read, and send messages in `#operator`
- Your Server ID matches the correct Discord server
- Your personal User ID is correct
- Your `#operator` Channel ID matches the actual channel
- Your Discord allowlist settings permit your account to communicate in that channel

> ***Important:*** *A bot appearing online in Discord does not necessarily prove it can read messages or respond correctly. The successful message-and-response test is what confirms your communication is working.*

Check 3 — Is Your AI Model Configured?

If your gateway and Discord connection appear healthy but your AI CEO still doesn't respond, check your AI model.

▷ TERMINAL COMMAND — COPY & PASTE INTO TERMINAL

```
openclaw models status
```

What to look for: Confirm that OpenClaw recognizes the AI model and provider you selected during installation. Review the output for:

- Missing authentication credentials
- Authentication errors
- Model availability issues
- Provider billing or usage-limit problems

If your model isn't configured correctly, return to the model setup instructions from Module 4A.

> ***Important:*** *A model appearing in your configuration doesn't necessarily mean it can successfully generate a response. The live Discord test is still the final confirmation.*

Check 4 — Verify Your Discord Bot Token

If Discord is reporting authentication or connection problems, your bot token may need attention.

In Module 4C, you saved your token in:

```
~/.openclaw/.env
```

Make sure the token you saved is the correct one from your Discord Developer Portal.

If you reset your token after completing Module 4C, your old token will no longer work. You'll need to update your environment file with the new token and restart the gateway before testing again.

> ***Do not reset your token simply because your AI CEO didn't respond.*** *Only reset or rotate it if the token was lost, revoked, exposed, or confirmed invalid. Never paste your real token into a public message or AI chat.*

Check 5 — Run OpenClaw's Diagnostic Tool

If you're still having trouble, OpenClaw has a built-in diagnostic tool.

▷ TERMINAL COMMAND — COPY & PASTE INTO TERMINAL

```
openclaw doctor
```

This can help identify configuration or installation issues. Review the output carefully. If the tool suggests changes, make sure you understand them before applying anything.

Do not delete your workspace or replace your configuration with an unrelated template.

⚡ Time Hack: Use ChatGPT to Fill This In Faster

Here's one of the easiest ways to get help when you're learning a new technical system. You can use ChatGPT to help interpret Terminal errors and guide you through troubleshooting, one step at a time.

You don't need to understand every technical message OpenClaw produces. And you don't need to guess which command to run next.

Here's what to do:

1. Copy the error message or Terminal output you're having trouble with
2. Remove any API keys, Discord Bot Tokens, passwords, or other sensitive data
3. Open ChatGPT or Grok
4. Paste the cleaned output along with the prompt below

Copy and paste this prompt:

> *I'm a complete beginner setting up my own AI CEO using OpenClaw and Discord. I've completed the installation lessons in the Build Your AI CEO course, and I'm currently on Module 4D — First Contact. I've started my OpenClaw gateway and attempted to send my first message to my AI CEO in Discord.*
>
> *I'm having the following issue:*
>
> *[DESCRIBE WHAT HAPPENED]*
>
> *Here is my Terminal output or error message:*
>
> *[PASTE YOUR TERMINAL OUTPUT HERE — REMOVE ALL PRIVATE KEYS AND TOKENS FIRST]*
>
> *I'm using [Mac / Windows with WSL2].*
>
> *Please act as a patient technical support expert and:*
> *1. Explain in simple, nontechnical language what the output means*
> *2. Tell me whether it indicates a normal message, a warning, or an actual error*
> *3. Identify the most likely cause without making assumptions that aren't supported by the output*
> *4. Walk me through the safest way to troubleshoot the problem, one step at a time*
> *5. Provide the exact Terminal command to copy and paste when needed*
> *6. Explain what I should expect to see after each step*
>
> *Please give me only ONE troubleshooting step at a time and wait for my response before continuing. Do not ask me to reveal credentials, overwrite my configuration, or delete files without explaining the risks. If a command may have changed in newer versions of OpenClaw, tell me to verify it against the official documentation.*
>
> ***Pro tip:** You can continue using the same ChatGPT conversation throughout your setup so it can follow the steps you've already completed and help you work through any issues that come up. Remember that AI assistants can occasionally suggest outdated or incorrect commands — verify unfamiliar instructions before running them.*

Up Next — Course Outro

You've built your AI CEO. Now what?

You've created the foundation. You've connected your AI CEO to Discord. And you've experienced First Contact.

In the course Outro, we'll explore how to build on what you've created, expand its capabilities, and begin turning your AI-powered system into real business value.

We'll also discuss three potential paths for using the skills and systems you've learned to create new income opportunities.

You've made it this far. And this is only the beginning.